parallel to the prevailing winds. These dunes are called Seifs in Sahara



Loess

The term loess refers to the deposits of fine silt and porous sand over a vast region. Extensive loess deposits are found in Northern and Western China, the Pampas of Argentina, in Ukraine and in the Mississippi Valley of the United States.



DO YOU KNOW?

The thickest known deposit of loess is, 335 metre found in the loess plateau in China.

Wave

A steady up (crest) and down (trough) movement of surface water are called waves. Sea waves are the most powerful agents of gradation and their erosional, transportational and depositional processes are confined to a very narrow belt along coastal areas.

Erosional Land Forms of Waves

Some of the erosional landforms of sea waves are **sea cliff, sea cave, arch, stack, beach, bar and spit and wave cut platform**.

1. Sea Cliffs

Sea cliffs are steep rock faces formed when sea waves dash against them. The rocks get eroded to form steep vertical walls.

2. Sea Cave

Prolonged wave attack on the base of a cliff erodes rock materials, which result in the formation of **caves**.

3. Sea Arch

When two caves approach one another from either side of a headland and unite, they form an **arch**. (Eg.) Neil Island, Andaman and Nicobar.



4. Sea Stack

Further erosion by waves ultimately leads to the total collapse of the arch. The seaward portion of the headland will remain as a pillar of rock known as **stack**. Eg the Old man of Hoy in Scotland.

5. Wave Cut Platforms

Flat surface found at the foot of sea cliffs are called as wave cut platforms. Wave cut platform is also referred as wave cut benches terrace.

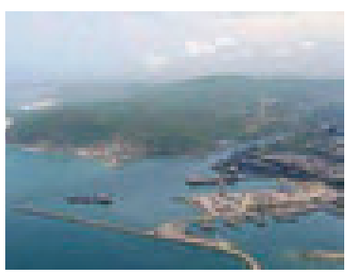
Depositional Landforms of Waves

Beach

Sand and gravel are moved and deposited by waves along the shore to form **beaches**. This is the most dominant and constructive work of the sea. (Eg.) Juhu beach along Mumbai coast, Puri beach in Odisha and Marina beach in Chennai.

Bar

A bar is an elongated deposit of sand, shingle or mud found in the sea, almost parallel to the shoreline.



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